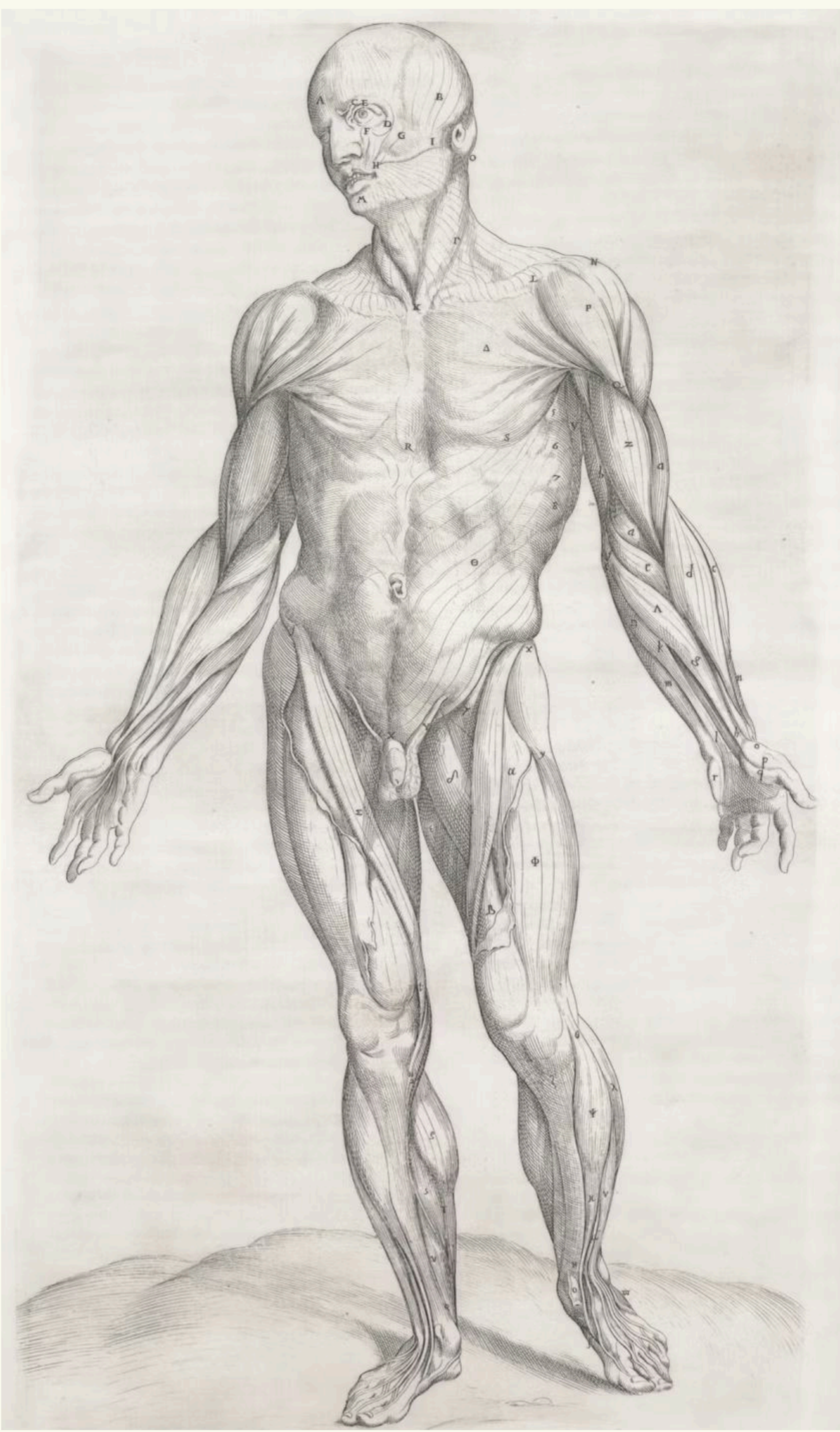
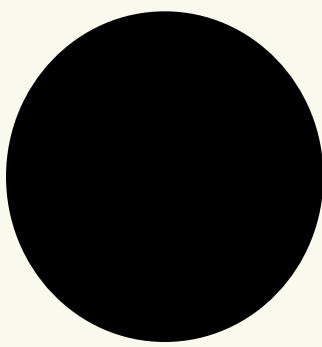


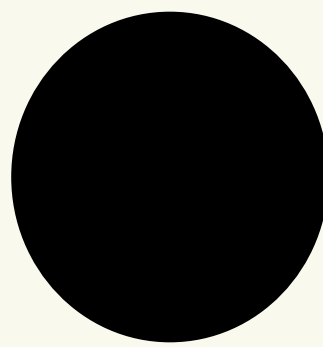


The Circular ruins
by Luis Borges

No one saw him disembark in the
unanimous **night**,

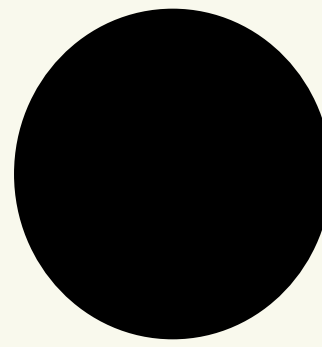


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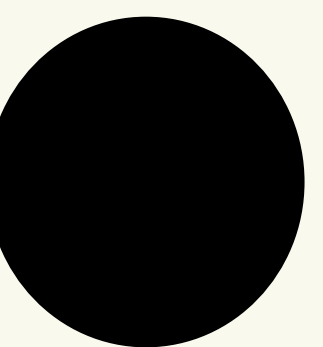


no one saw the bamboo canoe sink into the sacred mud,
but in a few days there was no one who did not know that the taciturn
man came from the South and that his home had been one of those
numberless villages upstream in the deeply cleft side of the mountain,
where the Zend language has not been contaminated by Greek and
where leprosy is infrequent.
What is certain is that the *grey* man kissed the mud, climbed up the
bank with pushing aside (probably, without *feeling*) the blades which
were lacerating his flesh, and crawled, nauseated and bloodstained, up
to the circular enclosure crowned with a stone tiger or horse, which
sometimes was the color of *flame* and now was that of *ashes*.

This circle was a temple which had
been devoured by ancient fires,
profaned by the miasmal jungle, and
whose god no longer received the
homage of men.

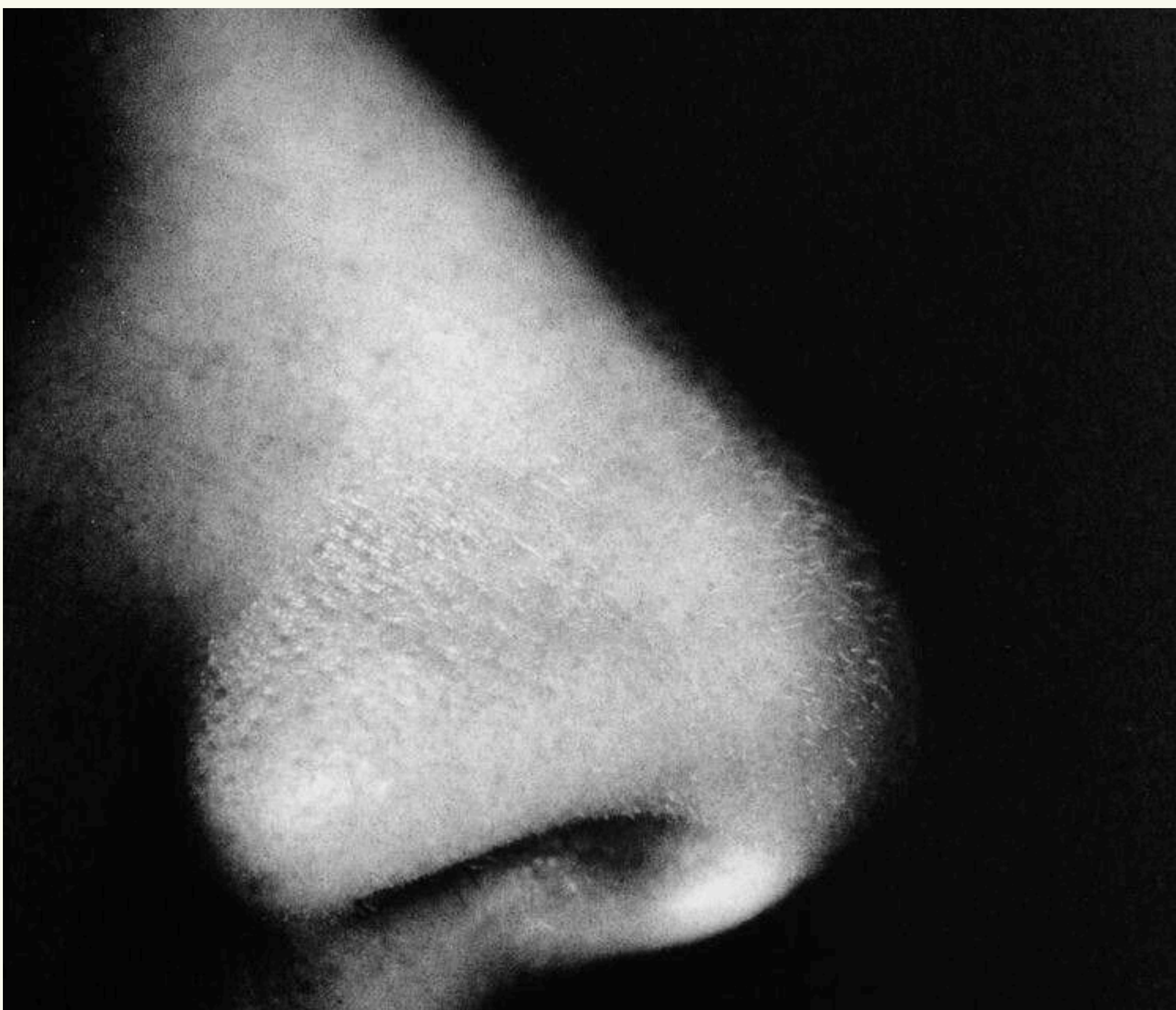
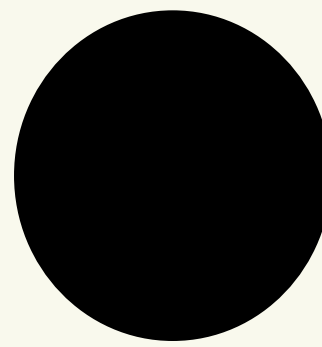


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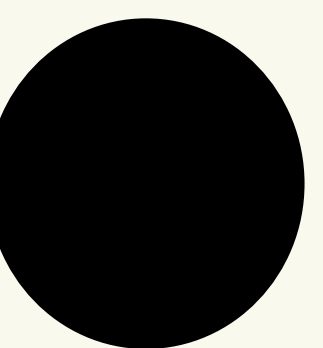


The stranger stretched himself out beneath the pedestal. He was
awakened by the sun high overhead. He was not astonished to find that
his wounds had healed; he closed his pallid eyes and slept, not through
weakness of flesh but through determination of will. He knew that this
temple was the place required for his invincible intent; he knew that
the incessant trees had not succeeded in strangling the ruins of another
propitious temple downstream which had once belonged to gods now
burned and dead; he knew that his immediate obligation was to dream.
Toward midnight he was awakened by the inconsolable shriek of a
bird.

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